

Avini and the Buzzing Helpers

By Pushpakanthie Wijekoon

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This book is about a little girl named Avini who learns to overcome her fear of bees by discovering how helpful they are to the Earth.

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Avini loved playing in her garden, but there was one thing that made her hide: the buzzing of a bee! She thought they were scary, with their stripes and their stingers.

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One sunny afternoon, a tiny bee, no bigger than her thumb, landed on a daisy right in front of her. Avini froze, ready to run. But this bee just wiggled its antennae and looked at her.

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“Hello!” buzzed the bee, a friendly sound. “My name is Bella. Why do you look so worried?” Avini blinked. A talking bee? “I ... I’m scared of bees,” she whispered.



Bella giggled, a tiny, happy buzz. “Oh, silly Avini! We bees are busy, not scary! We help the whole world bloom.”

Avini tilted her head. “How?”



“We fly from flower to flower,” Bella explained, doing a little dance in the air, “collecting sweet nectar and golden pollen. As we visit each bloom, we carry tiny bits of pollen from one flower to another.”



“That’s called pollination!” she continued. “It helps the flowers make seeds, which grow into new plants. Without us, many fruits and vegetables wouldn’t grow!”



Avini's eyes widened. "So, you help us have yummy apples and juicy strawberries?" Bella nodded. "And we make delicious honey, too! It's our special treat."

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Avini watched Bella fly from a rose to a sunflower, no longer feeling scared. She saw how gentle Bella was, and how important her work truly was.

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Later, Avini saw a wilting flower. She carefully watered it, hoping it would bloom again for Bella and her friends. She knew now that bees were helpers, not hurters.



From that day on, Avini wasn't afraid of bees. She waved to them as they buzzed by, happy to share her garden with her tiny, striped, very useful friends.

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